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BATTERY PACK LEAKAGE INSPECTION SYSTEM AND APPARATUS THEREFOR

Abstract

A battery pack leakage inspection system and an apparatus therefor are provided. The system includes: a base frame including a support on which a battery pack is placed; a first mask installed on the base frame to mask a coolant channel nipple of the battery pack; a second mask installed on the base frame separately from the first mask to mask a pressure regulator of the battery pack; and a third mask installed on the base frame separately from the second mask to mask a high voltage plug and an integrated charging control unit (ICCU) plug of the battery pack.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION(S)

[0001] The present application claims priority to and the benefit under 35 USC § 119 Korean Patent Application No. 10-2024-0031496, filed on Mar. 5, 2024, in the Korean Intellectual Property Office, the entire disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety for all purposes.

BACKGROUND

1. Field

[0002] The disclosure relates to a battery pack leakage inspection system and a battery pack leakage inspection apparatus.

2. Description of the Related Art

[0003] Battery packs used in electric vehicles and the like have a structure in which a plurality of battery cells are stacked and then electrically connected. The battery pack is a key component in the electric vehicle or the like, and thus required to be sealed to maintain airtightness for electrical stability and safety while being electrically connected to the outside.

[0004] In general, the battery pack is required to pass two leakage inspections for a coolant channel and a pack interior channel, and needs masking for a coolant channel nipple, a pressure regulator, etc. to undergo the two leakage inspections.

[0005] However, the coolant channel nipple and the pressure regulator are different in position according to vehicle models, and thus addition of a new vehicle model causes a problem of increasing investment costs due to the installation of a dedicated masking jig. As the number of vehicle models increases due to the recent rising demand for electric vehicles, the shapes of battery pack products are diversifying. Accordingly, there is a trend toward a common use of an automated system for various vehicles in an assembly process.

SUMMARY

[0006] This Summary is provided to introduce a selection of concepts in simplified form that are further described below in the Detailed Description. This Summary is not intended to identify key features or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to be used as an aid in determining the scope of the claimed subject matter.

[0007] An aspect of the disclosure is to provide a battery pack leakage inspection system that is developed for battery packs corresponding to various vehicle models, thereby reducing investment costs due to construction of common use facilities for various vehicle models and addition of new vehicle models.

[0008] Technical problems of the disclosure are not limited to the forementioned problems, and other unmentioned problems can be clearly understood from the following description by those skilled in the art.

[0009] In a general aspect of the disclosure, a battery pack leakage inspection system includes: a base frame including a support on which a battery pack is placed; a first mask installed on the base frame and configured to mask a coolant channel nipple of the battery pack; a second mask installed on the base frame separately from the first mask and configured to mask a pressure regulator of the battery pack; and a third mask installed on the base frame separately from the second mask and configured to mask a high voltage plug and an integrated charging control unit (ICCU) plug of the battery pack.

[0010] The first mask may include a first module and a second module, each of which is provided with a first masking jig connected to the coolant channel nipple, wherein the first module and the second module may respectively include multi-axis servo actuators configured to be driven individually to adjust a distance and an angle based on a position of the coolant channel nipple.

[0011] Each of the first module and the second module may include: a first base plate connected to a support plate and configured to move up and down along a Z-axis; a first operation plate connected to the first base plate and configured to move forward and backward along a Y-axis; a second operation plate connected to the first operation plate and configured to move forward and backward along an X-axis; and a jig plate connected to the second operation plate and configured to be rotatable around the Z-axis, the jig plate mounted with the first masking jig.

[0012] The battery pack leakage inspection system may further include: a unit plate connected to the base frame and configured to move forward and backward along the Y-axis, to which the support plate is secured, wherein the first module and the second module may be supported on the unit plate and configured to move as a single body.

[0013] The second mask may include a rotation module including a second masking jig connected to the pressure regulator of the battery pack, and a support module to which the rotation module is rotatably connected, wherein the rotation module may include at least one pair of rotation modules operating individually corresponding to the position of the pressure regulator and configured to be adjusted in position and angle.

[0014] The support module may include: a first body secured to a first support frame and configured to move forward and backward along the X-axis on the base frame, and provided with a ring gear; and a second body secured to a lower end of the first body and provided with a ring rail on a bottom surface thereof, wherein the rotation module may include: a prop connected to the ring rail; a first bracket disposed on the prop; a roller pinion rotatably connected to the first bracket and engaging with the ring gear; and a second bracket configured to move along the prop and mounted with the second masking jig.

[0015] The prop may include a structure configured to extend radially from a center of the ring gear, and rotate along the ring rail around the center of the ring gear.

[0016] The second masking jig may be mounted on the second bracket and configured to move up and down on the second bracket.

[0017] The third mask may include: a second support frame configured to move forward and backward along an X-axis on the base frame; a second base plate connected to the second support frame and configured to move up and down along a Z-axis; and a jig frame connected to the second base plate and configured to move forward and backward along a Y-axis, the jig frame mounted with a third masking jig to be connected to the high voltage plug and the ICCU plug.

[0018] The third masking jig may be mounted on the jig frame and configured to move forward and backward on the jig frame.

[0019] In another general aspect of the disclosure, a battery pack leakage inspection apparatus includes: a base frame including a support on which a battery pack is placed; a first mask installed on the base frame and configured to mask a coolant channel nipple of the battery pack, the first mask including: a first module including a first multi-axis servo actuator provided with a first masking jig connected to the coolant channel nipple; and a second module including a second multi-axis servo actuator provided with a second masking jig connected to the coolant channel nipple; a controller configured to control driving the first multi-axis servo actuator and the second multi-axis servo actuator to adjust distances and angles based on a position of the coolant channel nipple; a second mask installed on the base frame separately from the first mask and configured to mask a pressure regulator of the battery pack; and a third mask installed on the base frame separately from the second mask and configured to mask a high voltage plug and an integrated charging control unit (ICCU) plug of the battery pack.

[0020] Each of the first module and the second module may include: a first base plate connected to

a support plate; a first operation plate connected to the first base plate; a second operation plate connected to the first operation plate; and a jig plate connected to the second operation plate, the jig plate mounted with the first masking jig, wherein the controller may be further configured to: control movement of the first base plate to move up and down along a Z-axis; control movement of the first operation plate to move forward and backward along a Y-axis; control movement of the second operation plate to move forward and backward along an X-axis; and control rotation of the jig plate around the Z-axis.

[0021] The battery pack leakage inspection apparatus may further include: a unit plate connected to the base frame, wherein the controller may be further configured to control movement of the unit plate to move forward and backward along the Y-axis, to which the support plate is secured, wherein the first module and the second module may be supported on the unit plate and configured to move as a single body.

[0022] The second mask may include a rotation module including a second masking jig connected to the pressure regulator of the battery pack, and a support module to which the rotation module is rotatably connected, wherein the rotation module may include at least one pair of rotation modules operating individually corresponding to the position of the pressure regulator and configured to be adjusted in position and angle.

[0023] The support module may include: a first body secured to a first support frame and provided with a ring gear; and a second body secured to a lower end of the first body and provided with a ring rail on a bottom surface thereof, wherein the controller may be further configured to control movement of the first body to move forward and backward along the X-axis on the base frame, and wherein the rotation module may include: a prop connected to the ring rail; a first bracket disposed on the prop; a roller pinion rotatably connected to the first bracket and configured to engage with the ring gear; and a second bracket configured to move along the prop and mounted with the second masking jig.

[0024] The prop may include a structure configured to extend radially from a center of the ring gear, and rotate along the ring rail around the center of the ring gear.

[0025] The second masking jig may be mounted on the second bracket, wherein the controller may be further configured to control movement of the second masking jig to move up and down on the second bracket.

[0026] The third mask may include: a second support frame; a second base plate connected to the second support frame; a jig frame connected to the second base plate and mounted with a third masking jig for connection to the high voltage plug and the ICCU plug, wherein the controller may be further configured to: control movement of the second support frame to move forward and backward along an X-axis on the base frame; control movement of the second plate to move up and down along a Z-axis; and control movement of the jig frame to move forward and backward along a Y-axis.

[0027] The third masking jig may be mounted on the jig frame, wherein the controller may be further configured to control movement of the third masking jig to move forward and backward on the jig frame.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0028] FIG. 1 is a view schematically illustrating a battery pack leakage inspection system according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

[0029] FIG. 2 is a view schematically illustrating a battery pack to be subjected to a leakage inspection.

[0030] FIGS. 3 to 5 are plan, front and lateral views, respectively, illustrating a first masking unit in

a battery pack leakage inspection system, respectively.

[0031] FIG. **6** is a view illustrating a first masking jig of a first masking unit.

[0032] FIGS. **7** and **8** are plan and lateral views, respectively, illustrating a second masking unit in a battery pack leakage inspection system.

[0033] FIG. **9** is a plan view illustrating a coupling structure between a rotation module and a support module in a second masking unit.

[0034] FIG. **10** is a view illustrating a second masking jig of a second masking unit.

[0035] FIGS. **11** to **13** are plan, front and lateral views, respectively, illustrating a third masking unit in a battery pack leakage inspection system.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0036] The following detailed description is provided to assist the reader in gaining a comprehensive understanding of the methods, apparatuses, and/or systems described herein.

However, various changes, modifications, and equivalents of the methods, apparatuses, and/or systems described herein will be apparent after an understanding of the disclosure of this application. For example, the sequences of operations described herein are merely examples, and are not limited to those set forth herein, but may be changed as will be apparent after an understanding of the disclosure of this application, with the exception of operations necessarily occurring in a certain order.

[0037] The features described herein may be embodied in different forms and are not to be construed as being limited to the examples described herein. Rather, the examples described herein have been provided merely to illustrate some of the many possible ways of implementing the methods, apparatuses, and/or systems described herein that will be apparent after an understanding of the disclosure of this application.

[0038] Advantages and features of the present disclosure and methods of achieving the advantages and features will be clear with reference to embodiments described in detail below together with the accompanying drawings. However, the present disclosure is not limited to the embodiments disclosed herein but will be implemented in various forms. The embodiments of the present disclosure are provided so that the present disclosure is completely disclosed, and a person with ordinary skill in the art can fully understand the scope of the present disclosure. The present disclosure will be defined only by the scope of the appended claims. Meanwhile, the terms used in the present specification are for explaining the embodiments, not for limiting the present disclosure.

[0039] Terms, such as first, second, A, B, (a), (b) or the like, may be used herein to describe components. Each of these terminologies is not used to define an essence, order or sequence of a corresponding component but used merely to distinguish the corresponding component from other component(s). For example, a first component may be referred to as a second component, and similarly the second component may also be referred to as the first component.

[0040] Throughout the specification, when a component is described as being “connected to,” or “coupled to” another component, it may be directly “connected to,” or “coupled to” the other component, or there may be one or more other components intervening therebetween. In contrast, when an element is described as being “directly connected to,” or “directly coupled to” another element, there can be no other elements intervening therebetween.

[0041] In a description of the embodiment, in a case in which any one element is described as being formed on or under another element, such a description includes both a case in which the two elements are formed in direct contact with each other and a case in which the two elements are in indirect contact with each other with one or more other elements interposed between the two elements. In addition, when one element is described as being formed on or under another element, such a description may include a case in which the one element is formed at an upper side or a lower side with respect to another element.

[0042] The singular forms “a”, “an”, and “the” are intended to include the plural forms as well,

unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. It will be further understood that the terms “comprises/comprising” and/or “includes/including” when used herein, specify the presence of stated features, integers, steps, operations, elements, and/or components, but do not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, integers, steps, operations, elements, components and/or groups thereof.

[0043] Hereinafter, embodiments of the present invention will be described in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings, and components which are the same or correspond to each other will be denoted by the same or corresponding reference numerals in all drawings, and redundant descriptions will be omitted.

[0044] FIG. 1 is a view schematically illustrating a battery pack leakage inspection system according to an embodiment of the disclosure, and FIG. 2 is a view schematically illustrating a battery pack to be subjected to a leakage inspection.

[0045] Referring to FIGS. 1 and 2, the battery pack leakage inspection system according to an embodiment of the disclosure may include a first masking unit **100**, a second masking unit **200**, a third masking unit **300**, and a base frame **400**. The masking units may be referred to as masks, e.g., a first mask, a second mask, and a third mask. The battery pack leakage inspection system may include one or more controllers (e.g., processors) configured to control movement of various components described below.

[0046] The base frame **400** may form a frame structure for installing the first masking unit **100**, the second masking unit **200**, and the third masking unit **300**. The first masking unit **100**, the second masking unit **200**, and the third masking unit **300** may be installed separately from each other.

[0047] The base frame **400** may be provided with a support **410** on which a battery pack **10** is placed. According to an embodiment, the battery pack **10** may be transferred by a conveyor and seated on the support **410**.

[0048] As shown in FIG. 2, the battery pack **10** includes a coolant channel nipple **11** and a high voltage plug **12** on the front surface thereof, a high voltage plug **13** and an integrated charging control unit (ICCU) plug **14** on the rear surface thereof, and a pressure regulator **15** on the top surface thereof.

[0049] The first masking unit will be described with reference to FIGS. 3 to 6. FIGS. 3 to 5 show the first masking unit in the battery pack leakage inspection system, and FIG. 6 shows a first masking jig of the first masking unit.

[0050] The first masking unit **100** is installed on the base frame **400** and may be configured to mask the coolant channel nipple **11** of the battery pack **10**. According to an embodiment, the first masking unit **100** may be placed on the front surface of the battery pack **10**.

[0051] The first masking unit **100** may include a first module **100A** and the second module **100B**, each of which is provided with a first masking jig **170** connected to the coolant channel nipple **11**.

[0052] According to an embodiment, the first module **100A** and the second module **100B** are respectively configured as multi-axis servo actuators and driven individually to adjust distances and angles based on the positions of the coolant channel nipples **11**. In other words, the first module **100A** and the second module **100B** are symmetrically arranged left and right corresponding to two coolant channel nipples **11**, and driven each individually to adjust the distances and angles corresponding to the positions of the coolant channel nipple **11**.

[0053] Each of the first module **100A** and the second module **100B** may include a first base plate **110**, a first operation plate **120**, a second operation plate **130**, and a jig plate **140**.

[0054] The first base plate **110**, the first operation plate **120**, the second operation plate **130**, and the jig plate **140** may be configured to move along different axes.

[0055] The first base plate **110** may be connected to a support plate **150** so as to move up and down along the Z-axis. Here, the Z-axis may refer to a direction corresponding to up and down movement from above the top surface of the battery pack **10**.

[0056] The first base plate **110** may be connected to a first linear motion (LM) guide **151** extending

up and down along the surface of the vertically standing support plate **150**. Further, the first base plate **110** is connected to a first actuator **161** and moves up and down toward the top surface of the battery pack **10** along the first LM guide **151** through the operation of the first actuator **161**. According to an embodiment, the first actuator **161** may be based on a belt-pulley system including by a belt and a pulley.

[0057] The first base plate **110a** of the first module **100A** and the first base plate **110b** of the second module **100B** may be separated from each other and moved up and down individually. Therefore, the first base plate **110a** of the first module **100A** and the first base plate **110b** of the second module **100B** may be adjusted to be at different positions or at the same position along the Z-axis.

[0058] The first operation plate **120** may be connected to the first base plate **110** so as to move forward and backward along the Y-axis. Here, the Y-axis may refer to a direction corresponding to forward and backward movement toward the lateral surface of the battery pack **10**.

[0059] The first operation plate **120** may be connected to a second LM guide **111** extending from the surface of the first base plate **110** in a Y-axis direction. Further, the first operation plate **120** may be connected to a second actuator **162** and reciprocate forward and backward toward the lateral surface of the battery pack **10** along the second LM guide **111** through the operation of the second actuator **162**. According to an embodiment, the second actuator **162** may include an electric cylinder.

[0060] A first operation plate **120a** on the first base plate **110a** of the first module **100A** and a first operation plate **120b** on the first base plate **110b** of the second module **100B** may move each individually in the Y-axis direction.

[0061] The second operation plate **130** may be connected to the first operation plate **120** so as to move forward and backward along an X-axis. Here, the X-axis may refer to a direction corresponding to forward and backward movement toward the front surface of the battery pack **10**.

[0062] The second operation plate **130** may be connected to a third LM guide **121** extending from the surface of the first operation plate **120** in an X-axis direction. Further, the second operation plate **130** may be connected to a third actuator **163** and reciprocate forward and backward toward the front surface of the battery pack **10** along the third LM guide **121** through the operation of the third actuator **163**. According to an embodiment, the third actuator **163** may include an electric cylinder.

[0063] The second operation plate **130a** on the first operation plate **120a** of the first module **100A** and the second operation plate **130b** on the first operation plate **120b** of the second module **100B** may move each individually in the X-axis direction.

[0064] The jig plate **140** may be connected to the second operation plate **130** so as to rotate around the Z-axis. The jig plate **140** may be connected to a fourth actuator **164** on the second operation plate **130** and rotate through the operation of the fourth actuator **164**. According to an embodiment, the fourth actuator **164** may include a servo motor.

[0065] The first masking jig **170** may be mounted to the jig plate **140**. The first masking jig **170** may be selectively connected to the coolant channel nipple **11** while moving forward and backward through a forward-and-backward motion cylinder **166**.

[0066] The first masking jig **170** may be connected to the coolant channel nipple as moved forward, thereby masking the coolant channel nipple.

[0067] The first masking jig **170** may be provided with a urethane pad **171** inside a rear end thereof to be fastened to the jig plate **140**, so that the first masking jig **170** can tilt at a predetermined angle to the jig plate **140**. For example, the first masking jig **170** may use the elasticity of the urethane pad **171** to tilt at an angle of 4 to 5 degrees to the jig plate **140** so as to be easily coupled to the coolant channel nipple **11**.

[0068] The first masking jig **170** may be provided with an air hole **172**. The air hole **172** may be connected to an air injection pipe (not shown) and used to inspect the leakage of the coolant channel. While the coolant channel nipple **11** is masked with the end of the first masking jig **170**,

air may be injected into a coolant channel through the air hole **172**.

[0069] Each support plate **150** of the first module **100A** and the second module **100B** may be integrally secured to a unit plate **180**. The unit plate **180** may be connected to the base frame **400** so as to move forward and backward along the Y-axis.

[0070] The unit plate **180** may be connected to a fourth LM guide **181** extending to the base frame **400** in the Y-axis direction. Further, the unit plate **180** may be connected to a fifth actuator **165** and reciprocate forward and backward along the fourth LM guide **181** through the operation of the fifth actuator **165**. According to an embodiment, the fifth actuator **165** may include an electric cylinder.

[0071] Accordingly, the first module **100A** and the second module **100B** may be supported on the unit plate **180** and configured to move as a single unit.

[0072] When the battery pack **10** is transferred, the unit plate **180** moves to position the first module **100A** and the second module **100B** to face toward the coolant channel nipple **11** provided in front of the battery pack **10**. In addition, the first module **100A** and the second module **100B** may be driven individually to adjust the distance and angle corresponding to the position of the coolant channel nipple **11**. In other words, each first masking jig **170** moves along the Z-axis, the Y-axis, and the X-axis to face the coolant channel nipple **11**, and rotates. Then, the first masking jig **170** moves forward to mask the coolant channel nipple **11**.

[0073] With this method, the first masking jig **170** may be adjusted to be positioned and directed corresponding to the position and direction of the coolant channel nipple **11** of the battery pack **10** even though the coolant channel nipples **11** of the battery packs **10** are different in position and direction according to the vehicle models.

[0074] The second masking unit will be described with reference to FIGS. 7 to 10. FIGS. 7 and 8 show the second masking unit in a battery pack leakage inspection system, FIG. 9 shows a coupling structure between a rotation module and a support module in the second masking unit, and FIG. 10 shows a second masking jig of the second masking unit.

[0075] The second masking unit **200** may be installed on the base frame **400** separately from the first masking unit **100**, and configured to mask the pressure regulator **15** provided on the top surface of the battery pack **10**. The second masking unit **200** may be installed on the base frame **400** so as to be placed above the top surface of the battery pack **10**.

[0076] The second masking unit **200** may include a rotation module **200A** including a second masking jig **260** connected to the pressure regulator **15**, and a support module **200B** supporting the rotation module **200A**.

[0077] The support module **200B** may include a first body **220** secured to a first support frame **210** moving forward and backward on the base frame **400** along the X-axis on the base frame **400**, and a second body **230** secured to a lower end of the first body **220**.

[0078] The first support frame **210** may be connected to a fifth LM guide **211** extending on the base frame **400** along the X-axis. The first support frame **210** may be connected to a sixth actuator **271** and reciprocate forward and backward along the fifth LM guide **211** through the operation of the sixth actuator **271**. According to an embodiment, the sixth actuator **271** may include an electric cylinder.

[0079] The first body **220** may be mounted and secured to the bottom surface of the first support frame **210**. The first body **220** may be provided with a ring gear **221** on the circumference thereof. The ring gear **221** may have a structure that gear teeth protrude radially from the center of the first body **220**.

[0080] The second body **230** may be shaped like a disk having a diameter approximately larger than the diameter of the ring gear **221**.

[0081] The second body **230** may be provided with a ring rail **231** concentric with the ring gear **221** on the bottom surface thereof facing the battery pack **10**. There may be provided a single rail **231** or a plurality of ring rails **231**. In this embodiment, there are provided two ring rails **231**, i.e., a first ring rail **231a** and a second ring rail **231b** different in diameter from each other, but the disclosure

is not limited to this embodiment.

[0082] The rotation module **200A** may be rotatably connected to the support module **200B**. The rotation module **200A** may be provided as a pair corresponding to the pressure regulators **15**. In this embodiment, there is provided one pair of rotation modules **200A**, but the disclosure is not limited to this embodiment.

[0083] One pair of rotation modules **200A** may be configured to operate individually and be adjusted in position and angle corresponding to the positions of the pressure regulators **15**.

[0084] Referring to FIGS. **7** to **10**, the rotation module **200A** may include a prop **240** connected to the ring rail **231** on the bottom surface of the second body **230**, a first bracket **241** disposed on the prop **240**, a roller pinion **250** rotatably connected to the first bracket **241**, a second bracket **242** configured to move along the prop **240**, and the second masking jig **260** mounted to the second bracket **242**.

[0085] The prop **240** may be roughly shaped like a long beam, and disposed to have a structure of extending radially from the center of the ring gear **221**. Further, the prop **240** may rotate along the ring rail **231** around the center of the ring gear **221**.

[0086] The first bracket **241** may be provided on the prop **240**, and the roller pinion **250** may be rotatably connected to the first bracket **241** and engage with the ring gear **221**. According to an embodiment, the roller pinion **250** may be connected to a servo motor **272** and driven to rotate. As the roller pinion **250** rotates in the state that the roller pinion **250** engages with the ring gear **221**, the prop **240** rotates along the ring rail **231**.

[0087] The second bracket **242** is provided below the prop **240**, and the second bracket **242** may move along the prop **240**. The second bracket **242** may be connected to a seventh actuator **273** and reciprocate forward and backward along the prop **240** through the operation of the seventh actuator **273**. According to an embodiment, the seventh actuator **273** may include an electric cylinder.

[0088] The second masking jig **260** may be mounted to move up and down on the second bracket **242**. According to an embodiment, the second masking jig **260** may be selectively connected to the pressure regulator while moving up and down through an up-and-down motion cylinder **274**. The second masking jig **260** is connected to the pressure regulator **15** as moved down, thereby masking the pressure regulator **15**.

[0089] The second masking jig **260** may be provided with a urethane pad **261** inside a rear end thereof to be fastened to the up-and-down motion cylinder **274**, so that the second masking jig **260** can tilt at a predetermined angle. For example, the second masking jig **260** may use the elasticity of the urethane pad **261** to tilt at an angle of 4 to 5 degrees so as to be easily coupled to the pressure regulator **15**.

[0090] The second masking jig **260** may be provided with an air hole **262**. The air hole **262** may be connected to the air injection pipe and used to inspect the leakage inside the battery pack **10**. While the pressure regulator **15** is masked with the end of the second masking jig **260**, air may be injected into the battery pack **10** through the air hole **262**.

[0091] When the battery pack **10** is transferred, the first support frame **210** moves to position the support module **200B** and the rotation module **200A** above the pressure regulators **15** provided on the top surface of the battery pack **10**. In addition, one pair of rotation modules **200A** may be driven individually to adjust the position and angle corresponding to the position of the pressure regulators **15**. In other words, each second masking jig **260** rotates along the ring rail **231** to face the pressure regulator **15**, and moves forward and backward along the prop **240**. Then, the second masking jig **260** moves down to mask the pressure regulator **15**.

[0092] With this method, the second masking jig **260** may be adjusted to be positioned corresponding to the position of the pressure regulator **15** of the battery pack **10** even though the pressure regulators **15** of the battery packs **10** are different in position according to the vehicle models.

[0093] The third masking unit will be described with reference to FIGS. **11** to **13**. FIGS. **11** to **13**

show the third masking unit in the battery pack leakage inspection system.

[0094] The third masking unit **300** may be installed on the base frame **400** separately from the second masking unit **200**, and configured to mask the high voltage plugs **12** and **13** provided on the front and rear surfaces of the battery pack **10** and the ICCU plug **14** provided on the rear surface of the battery pack **10**. According to an embodiment, the third masking unit **300** may be provided as a pair and placed on the front and rear surfaces of the battery pack **10**, respectively.

[0095] The third masking unit **300** may include a second support frame **310** moving forward and backward on the base frame **400** along the X-axis, a second base plate **320** connected to the second support frame **310**, and a jig frame **330** connected to the second base plate **320**.

[0096] The second support frame **310** may be connected to a sixth LM guide **311** extending on the base frame **400** along the X-axis. The second support frame **310** may be connected to an eighth actuator **351** and reciprocate forward and backward along the sixth LM guide **311** through the operation of the eighth actuator **351**. According to an embodiment, the eighth actuator **351** may be based on a belt-pulley system including by a belt and a pulley.

[0097] The second base plate **320** may be connected to the second support frame **310** so as to move up and down along the Z-axis.

[0098] The second base plate **320** may be connected to a seventh LM guide **312** extending from the second support frame **310** in the Z-axis direction. Further, the second base plate **320** may be connected to a ninth actuator **352** and reciprocate up and down along the seventh LM guide **312** through the operation of the ninth actuator **352**. According to an embodiment, the ninth actuator **352** may be based on a belt-pulley system including by a belt and a pulley.

[0099] The jig frame **330** may be connected to the second base plate **320** so as to move forward and backward along the Y-axis.

[0100] The jig frame **330** may be connected to an eighth LM guide **321** extending from the second base plate **320** in the Y-axis direction. Further, the jig frame **330** may be connected to a tenth actuator **353** and reciprocate forward and backward along the eighth LM guide **321** through the operation of the tenth actuator **353**. According to an embodiment, the tenth actuator **353** may include an electric cylinder.

[0101] A third masking jig **340** may be mounted to the jig frame **330**. The third masking jig **340** may be selectively connected to the high voltage plugs **12** and **13** and the ICCU plug **14** as mounted to move forward and backward through a forward-and-backward motion cylinder **354**.

[0102] The third masking jig **340** may be connected to the high voltage plugs **12** and **13** and the ICCU plug **14** as moved forward, thereby masking the high voltage plugs **12** and **13** and the ICCU plug **14**.

[0103] The third masking jig **340** may be provided with a urethane pad **341** inside a rear end thereof to be fastened to the forward-and-backward motion cylinder **354**, so that the third masking jig **340** can tilt at a predetermined angle. For example, the third masking jig **340** may use the elasticity of the urethane pad **341** to tilt at an angle of about 4 to 5 degrees so as to be easily coupled to the high voltage plugs **12** and **13** and the ICCU plug **14**.

[0104] Meanwhile, the leakage inspection for the battery pack **10** may be performed through the first masking unit **100** and the second masking unit **200**.

[0105] In the state that the first masking unit **100** is driven to mask the coolant channel nipple **11** with the first masking jig **170**, air is injected into the coolant channel through the air hole **172** provided in the first masking jig **170**. The amount of air to be injected and an injection time may be controlled and checked through a control device **500**.

[0106] When the injection of air is completed, it is checked whether there is a change in the amount of injected air. When the change in the amount of injected air satisfies an airtightness condition, it is identified that there is no problem with the coolant channel.

[0107] In the state that the second masking unit **200** is driven to mask the pressure regulator **15** with the second masking jig **260**, air is injected into the battery pack **10** through the air hole **262**

provided in the second masking jig **260**. The amount of air to be injected and an injection time may be controlled and checked through a control device **500**.

[0108] When the injection of air is completed, it is checked whether there is a change in the amount of injected air. When the change in the amount of injected air satisfies an airtightness condition, it is identified that there is no problem with a packaging state of the battery pack **10**. In other words, the airtightness in the battery pack **10** is guaranteed.

[0109] In this way, according to an embodiment of the disclosure, the masking jigs **170**, **260**, and **340** are automatically adjustable in position, angle and direction and thus used in common regardless of vehicle models even though the battery packs are different in shape according to the vehicle models. Accordingly, common use facilities for various vehicle models are constructed, thereby reducing investment costs due to addition of new vehicle models.

[0110] According to an embodiment of the disclosure, there is provided a battery pack leakage inspection system to reduce investment costs due to construction of common use facilities for various vehicle models and addition of new vehicle models.

[0111] The effects of the disclosure are not limited to the foregoing effects, and other unmentioned effects can be clearly understood from the appended claims by those skilled in the art.

[0112] Although a few embodiments of the disclosure have been described, it will be understood by a person having ordinary knowledge in the art that various modifications and changes can be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure set forth in the appended claims. In addition, differences related to these modifications and changes should be construed as falling within the scope of the disclosure defined in the appended claims.

Claims

1. A battery pack leakage inspection system comprising: a base frame comprising a support on which a battery pack is placed; a first mask installed on the base frame and configured to mask a coolant channel nipple of the battery pack; a second mask installed on the base frame separately from the first mask and configured to mask a pressure regulator of the battery pack; and a third mask installed on the base frame separately from the second mask and configured to mask a high voltage plug and an integrated charging control unit (ICCU) plug of the battery pack.
2. The battery pack leakage inspection system of claim 1, wherein the first mask comprises a first module and a second module, each of which is provided with a first masking jig connected to the coolant channel nipple, and wherein the first module and the second module respectively comprise multi-axis servo actuators configured to be driven individually to adjust a distance and an angle based on a position of the coolant channel nipple.
3. The battery pack leakage inspection system of claim 2, wherein each of the first module and the second module comprises: a first base plate connected to a support plate and configured to move up and down along a Z-axis; a first operation plate connected to the first base plate and configured to move forward and backward along a Y-axis; a second operation plate connected to the first operation plate and configured to move forward and backward along an X-axis; and a jig plate connected to the second operation plate and configured to be rotatable around the Z-axis, the jig plate mounted with the first masking jig.
4. The battery pack leakage inspection system of claim 3, further comprising: a unit plate connected to the base frame and configured to move forward and backward along the Y-axis, to which the support plate is secured, wherein the first module and the second module are supported on the unit plate and configured to move as a single body.
5. The battery pack leakage inspection system of claim 1, wherein the second mask comprises a rotation module including a second masking jig connected to the pressure regulator of the battery pack, and a support module to which the rotation module is rotatably connected, and wherein the rotation module comprises at least one pair of rotation modules operating individually

corresponding to the position of the pressure regulator and configured to be adjusted in position and angle.

6. The battery pack leakage inspection system of claim 5, wherein the support module comprises: a first body secured to a first support frame and configured to move forward and backward along the X-axis on the base frame, and provided with a ring gear; and a second body secured to a lower end of the first body and provided with a ring rail on a bottom surface thereof, and wherein the rotation module comprises: a prop connected to the ring rail; a first bracket disposed on the prop; a roller pinion rotatably connected to the first bracket and engaging with the ring gear; and a second bracket configured to move along the prop and mounted with the second masking jig.

7. The battery pack leakage inspection system of claim 6, wherein the prop comprises a structure configured to: extend radially from a center of the ring gear; and rotate along the ring rail around the center of the ring gear.

8. The battery pack leakage inspection system of claim 6, wherein the second masking jig is mounted on the second bracket and configured to move up and down on the second bracket.

9. The battery pack leakage inspection system of claim 1, wherein the third mask comprises: a second support frame configured to move forward and backward along an X-axis on the base frame; a second base plate connected to the second support frame and configured to move up and down along a Z-axis; and a jig frame connected to the second base plate and configured to move forward and backward along a Y-axis, the jig frame mounted with a third masking jig to be connected to the high voltage plug and the ICCU plug.

10. The battery pack leakage inspection system of claim 9, wherein the third masking jig is mounted on the jig frame and configured to move forward and backward on the jig frame.

11. A battery pack leakage inspection apparatus comprising: a base frame comprising a support on which a battery pack is placed; a first mask installed on the base frame and configured to mask a coolant channel nipple of the battery pack, the first mask including: a first module comprising a first multi-axis servo actuator provided with a first masking jig connected to the coolant channel nipple; and a second module comprising a second multi-axis servo actuator provided with the first masking jig connected to the coolant channel nipple; a controller configured to control driving the first multi-axis servo actuator and the second multi-axis servo actuator to adjust distances and angles based on a position of the coolant channel nipple; a second mask installed on the base frame separately from the first mask and configured to mask a pressure regulator of the battery pack; and a third mask installed on the base frame separately from the second mask and configured to mask a high voltage plug and an integrated charging control unit (ICCU) plug of the battery pack.

12. The battery pack leakage inspection apparatus of claim 11, wherein each of the first module and the second module comprises: a first base plate connected to a support plate; a first operation plate connected to the first base plate; a second operation plate connected to the first operation plate; and a jig plate connected to the second operation plate, the jig plate mounted with the first masking jig, and wherein the controller is further configured to: control movement of the first base plate to move up and down along a Z-axis; control movement of the first operation plate to move forward and backward along a Y-axis; control movement of the second operation plate to move forward and backward along an X-axis; and control rotation of the jig plate around the Z-axis.

13. The battery pack leakage inspection apparatus of claim 12, further comprising: a unit plate connected to the base frame, wherein the controller is further configured to control movement of the unit plate to move forward and backward along the Y-axis, to which the support plate is secured, wherein the first module and the second module are supported on the unit plate and configured to move as a single body.

14. The battery pack leakage inspection apparatus of claim 11, wherein the second mask comprises a rotation module including a second masking jig connected to the pressure regulator of the battery pack, and a support module to which the rotation module is rotatably connected, and wherein the rotation module comprises at least one pair of rotation modules operating individually

corresponding to the position of the pressure regulator and configured to be adjusted in position and angle.

15. The battery pack leakage inspection apparatus of claim 14, wherein the support module comprises: a first body secured to a first support frame and provided with a ring gear; and a second body secured to a lower end of the first body and provided with a ring rail on a bottom surface thereof, wherein the controller is further configured to control movement of the first body to move forward and backward along the X-axis on the base frame, and wherein the rotation module comprises: a prop connected to the ring rail; a first bracket disposed on the prop; a roller pinion rotatably connected to the first bracket and configured to engage with the ring gear; and a second bracket configured to move along the prop and mounted with the second masking jig.

16. The battery pack leakage inspection apparatus of claim 15, wherein the prop comprises a structure configured to: extend radially from a center of the ring gear; and rotate along the ring rail around the center of the ring gear.

17. The battery pack leakage inspection apparatus of claim 16, wherein the second masking jig is mounted on the second bracket, and wherein the controller is further configured to control movement of the second masking jig to move up and down on the second bracket.

18. The battery pack leakage inspection apparatus of claim 11, wherein the third mask comprises: a second support frame; a second base plate connected to the second support frame; a jig frame connected to the second base plate and mounted with a third masking jig for connection to the high voltage plug and the ICCU plug, and wherein the controller is further configured to: control movement of the second support frame to move forward and backward along an X-axis on the base frame; control movement of the second plate to move up and down along a Z-axis; and control movement of the jig frame to move forward and backward along a Y-axis.

19. The battery pack leakage inspection apparatus of claim 18, wherein the third masking jig is mounted on the jig frame, and wherein the controller is further configured to control movement of the third masking jig to move forward and backward on the jig frame.
